



Republic of the Philippines
Department of Education
SOCCSKSARGEN REGION

02 Sept 2026

REGIONAL MEMORANDUM

No. 050 s. 2026

**REITERATION OF THE MANDATORY ADOPTION AND IMPLEMENTATION OF
DEPED ORDER NO. 015, S. 2026 REVISED GUIDELINES ON CLASSROOM
ASSESSMENT, GRADING SYSTEM, AND AWARDS AND RECOGNITION
FOR THE K TO 12 BASIC EDUCATION PROGRAM**

To: Schools Division Superintendents

1. This is to reiterate the mandatory adoption, strict compliance with, and nation-wide implementation of DepEd Order (DO) No. 015, s. 2026, titled "**Revised Guidelines on Classroom Assessment, Grading System, and Awards and Recognition for the K to 12 Basic Education Program**," starting School Year (SY) 2026–2027. This landmark reform replaces previous outdated policies specifically DO No. 8, s. 2015 and DO No. 36, s. 2016 to systematically address critical issues in classroom assessment particularly grade inflation, overreliance on arbitrary transmutation, inconsistent promotion standards, and the lack of standardized, objective evidence of learning to guide classroom instruction.

2. Assessment under the revised basic education curriculum is a core pedagogical component rather than a compliance task. As such, a learner's grade must represent an honest, transparent, and accurate measure of their actual mastery of curriculum content and learning competencies. **The practice of mass promotion is strictly prohibited across all grade levels.** Grade-level promotion must be earned through verified scholastic progress, academic integrity, and demonstrated competency achievement.

3. Upholding grading standards is essential to ensure that academic interventions are routed effectively. Lowering classroom passing standards or artificially adjusting learner grades disguises learning gaps and deprives struggling learners of critical remedial support. Keeping assessment results accurate and objective guarantees that school-level and national remediation programs such as the Academic Recovery for Accessible Learning (ARAL) Program and various School Initiated Interventions (SII) are targeted to the right learners who genuinely require foundational literacy, numeracy, and academic assistance.

4. To preserve the academic integrity of the educational system, the professional judgment and grading authority of classroom teachers must be protected. **No School Principal, School Head, Public Schools District Supervisor, or other administrative official shall require, pressure, or coerce teachers to pass any learner** who has not satisfactorily demonstrated competency improvement or met the minimum standard of proficiency (Final Grade of 75).

5. Promotion or passing grades must be justified and supported strictly by **verifiable, objective, and documented proof of learning progress** through the



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three mandated grading components for Key Stages 2 to 4 (Grades 4 to 12). Teachers are directed to maintain complete, accurate, and up-to-date class records.

6. **To clarify, the recommended range of two (2) to three (3) Performance Tasks (PTs) per learning area, per term, serves as flexible guidance for teachers and should not be construed as a rigid or mandatory compliance requirement. Over-assessment and excessive checking must be strictly avoided to prevent cognitive fatigue and protect instructional time.**

7. In the event that a learner fails to obtain a passing mark (Final Grade below 75) in any learning area at the end of the School Year, schools are **directed to strictly adhere to the standardized promotion and retention guidelines detailed under Section VIII of DO No. 015, s. 2026**. Under no circumstances shall arbitrary local adjustments be made. The following structured sequence of interventions must be followed:

- A. End-of-School-Year Summer Remedial Classes (SRC): Learners who fail in at most two (2) learning areas at the end of the school year shall undergo **mandatory Summer Remedial Classes (SRC)** conducted as part of the EOSY Intervention Program. Upon completion, their Remedial Class Mark (RCM) and Final Grade (FG) shall be averaged. Only learners who obtain a Recomputed Final Grade (RFG) of 75 or higher shall be cleared for promotion.
- B. Conditional Promotion and Back Subjects: Learners who still fail to meet the passing standards in one (1) or two (2) learning areas after the SRC shall be **conditionally promoted** to the next grade level. These deficiencies shall be officially classified as **back subjects**. The learner must complete these deficiencies through a School-Initiated Intervention (SII) alongside their other regular subjects.
- C. Key Constraints on Back Subjects (Maximum of One per Term): To manage the learner's academic workload and prevent severe cognitive fatigue, conditionally promoted learners shall only be permitted to take and clear one (1) back subject per term under SII. A passing RFG of 75 is required to officially clear each back subject.
- D. Prerequisite Subject Block (Prerequisite Restriction): For cumulative learning areas (such as Mathematics), a failure in a prerequisite lower-level subject (e.g., Grade 3 Math) prevents enrollment, credit, or official instruction in the higher-level subject (e.g., Grade 4 Math) in the next grade level until the prerequisite deficiency is cleared with a passing RFG of 75. To prevent academic overload and manage learner stress, interventions for back subjects must be highly focused and time-bound. Under the School-Initiated Intervention (SII), teachers are advised to use a compressed, intensive timeframe (such as 15 class days) to address only the essential, least-mastered competencies for the back subject. Once these foundational gaps are resolved, the student should begin attending the regular grade-level class. Teachers shall continue to provide parallel, low-demand academic support and monitoring until the learner has fully caught up with the rest of the class.
- E. Grade-Level Retention: Learners who fail in more than two (2) learning areas at the end of the school year or who carry uncleared back subjects that, when combined with current grade-level failures, total more than two (2)



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- deficient learning areas shall be officially retained in their current grade level. Grade-level retention must be supported by a customized intervention plan drafted by the homeroom advisor and subject teachers.
8. Subject teachers and homeroom advisers shall systematically communicate the prescribed, sequential academic recovery protocols—specifically the Summer Remedial Classes (SRC) and School-Initiated Interventions (SII) to affected learners and their parents or legal guardians, ensuring complete transparency and cooperation in addressing learning deficiencies.
9. All School Heads shall conduct dedicated Learning Action Cell (LAC) sessions to re-orient all teaching staff on classroom-based assessment strategies, standard grading weights, adjusted transmutation calculations, and Key Stage 1 descriptive grading guidelines and other details stipulated in DO 15, s.2026.
10. The Division Curriculum Implementation Division (CID), through Education Program Supervisors, will conduct systematic checks of school grading sheets, class records, PACE Forms, and learner portfolios during monitoring visits.
11. Strict compliance with and immediate dissemination of this Memorandum is desired.


ATTY. ALBERTO T. ESCOBARTE, CESO II
Regional Director

Encl: None
Reference: DO 15, 2026
Allotment: None
To be included in the Perpetual Index
under the following subject:

ASSESSMENT

JRSL/CLMD/RM-REITERATION OF THE MANDATORY ADOPTION AND IMPLEMENTATION OF DEPED ORDER NO. 015, S. 2026
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249/September 2, 2026

ROC 07